
Mia & Olivia
The Ding-Ding Street Challenge
A Pick It Up Seattle Story
By Tricia Tomlinson
CAPTAIN CAN
One person.
One piece.
One better place.


Mia was halfway through breakfast
when her phone went—
DING!
She dropped her spoon.
"THE STREET CHALENGE!"


Outside, Olivia was already waiting.
Gloves? On.
Grabber? Ready.
Smile? ENORMOUS.
"I've been ready since breakfast," she said.
"It IS breakfast," said Mia.


Captain Can marched around the corner.
"I have prepared a very inspiring speech."
Mia's phone chimed.
Olivia's phone chimed.
Both girls dashed past him.
"...And that was my speech," he said.


Their screens lit up.
Mia tapped her avatar.
Olivia tapped hers.
Captain Can leaned closer.
"Which button makes me taller?"
STREET CHALLENGE
CHOOSE YOUR PLAYER!
STREET CHALLENGE
CHOOSE YOUR PLAYER!


They checked their equipment.
Mia squeezed her grabber.
CLICK! CLICK!
Olivia squeezed hers.
CLACK! CLACK!
Captain Can stepped backward.
"I suddenly feel like a very large snack."
CAPTAIN CAN


An adult helper joined them at the sidewalk.
"Ready, you two?"
"Ready!" said Mia.
"Ready!" said Olivia.
"I was BORN ready!" declared Captain Can.
His lid slipped over his eyes.
Mostly."
CAPTAIN CAN

Mia spotted the first messy patch.

"Before photo!"

She aimed her camera.

Olivia checked hers too.

"Wait," said Mia. "Why is everything pink?"

Her finger was covering the lens.




Olivia pointed her camera at the litter.
Captain Can sprang into the picture.
"Hero pose!"
"Captain Can..."
"BIGGER hero pose!"
"We need to see the litter."
"Oh. Less hero."
CAPTAIN CAN


CLICK! CLICK!
Two before photos.
Two ready players.
One Captain Can trying very hard
to stand still.
"Can I breathe?"
"Yes."
"Dramatically?"
CAPTAIN CAN


Mia grabbed a wrapper.
Olivia grabbed a paper cup.
Mia grabbed another wrapper.
Olivia grabbed—
"A sock?"
Captain Can gasped.
"The foot has escaped!"
CAPTAIN CAN


A breeze caught Mia's next wrapper.
It skipped left.
It skittered right.
Mia followed with her grabber.
"Come BACK, you tiny potato-chip flag!"
CAPTAIN CAN


Olivia waited beside a bush.
The wrapper fluttered straight toward her.
SNIP! "Got it!"
Mia laughed.
"I loosened it up for you."
"Excellent teamwork," said Captain Can.
CAPTAIN CAN


Their first patches looked wonderful.
"After photos!" called Mia.
Both girls checked their cameras.
Same spots.
Much better views.
Captain Can peeked around the edge.
"Just one little hero pose?"
CAPTAIN CAN


They sent their pictures.
For one long moment, nothing happened.
Mia stared. Olivia stared.
Captain Can stared.
"Perhaps," he whispered,
"we have frightened the phones."
Then–
DING! DING!
CAPTAIN CAN


Stars burst across both screens.
A shiny badge popped into place.
Mia bounced. Olivia twirled.
Captain Can attempted both.
His lid went BONK!
FIRST CLEANUP COMPLETE!
CAPTAIN CAN
FIRST CLEANUP COMPLETE!


Mia opened the leaderboard.
"Look! I'm ahead!"
Olivia leaned over.
"By two points."
"Two very handsome points," said Mia.
Captain Can nodded.
"Excellent posture on those points."
CAPTAIN CAN
STREET LEADERBOARD
Mia 12
Olivia 10


They headed toward the next messy spot.
Olivia found three cups.
Mia found two cans.
Captain Can found a bench.
"I shall supervise from here."
A pigeon was already sitting on it.
"Apparently, I have an assistant."
CAPTAIN CAN


Under the bench, Olivia spotted more litter.
"There you are!"
She crouched. She reached.
She stretched her grabber.
The pigeon watched closely.
"Don't worry," she told it.
"You aren't worth any points."
CAPTAIN CAN


Mia's phone chimed again.
"Look! Two coins!"
Olivia held up her screen.
"I got two too!"
Captain Can examined his chest.
"I have a sticker."
It said BANANAS.
Treasure chest
+2 coins
Treasure chest
+2 coins
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


They checked the leaderboard again.
Olivia was ahead.
Mia blinked.
Then she looked at Olivia's growing collection bag.
"You've been BUSY."
Olivia grinned.
"So has the pigeon."
STREET LEADERBOARD
Olivia 18
Mia 16
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


Mia hurried toward a bright yellow shape.
"One more!"
She reached with her grabber—
Then stopped.
It was a flower.
Captain Can cleared his throat.
"That one appears to be attached to the planet."
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


Mia laughed so hard she had to sit down.
Olivia laughed too.
Even their adult helper was laughing.
Captain Can stood beside the flower.
"I have saved this citizen."
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


The girls took a water break.
Mia looked at the leaderboard.
Still second.
She twisted her bottle cap.
"I really wanted to win."
Olivia lowered her bottle.
"So did I."
For a moment, neither said anything.
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


Then Mia nudged Olivia's shoe.
"You're having a REALLY good game."
Olivia smiled.
"So are you."
Captain Can leaned between them.
"I'm having an excellent banana."
He pointed proudly at his sticker.
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS

Their phones flashed.

FINAL MINUTES!

Mia sprang up. Olivia grabbed her bag.

Captain Can raised one arm.

"To the finish!"

The pigeon flapped away.

"My assistant has another appointment."



Near the last bush, Olivia found a whole pocket of litter. Mia spotted a cup beside the path. They checked their cameras. CLICK! Grabbers clicked. Bags rustled. Nobody had time for a hero pose.




"After photos!" Mia called.
Olivia checked her picture.
"Mine's ready!"
Mia checked hers. "Mine too!"
They tapped their screens.
Captain Can held his breath.
Then—DING! DING!
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


STREET WINNER:
OLIVIA!
Stars swirled across her screen.
HERO TITLE EARNED:
OCEAN OLIVIA!
NEIGHBORHOOD CHALLENGE
UNLOCKED!
STREET WINNER: OLIVIA!
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


"Ocean Olivia?" she whispered.
Then she jumped.
"OCEAN OLIVIA!"
Captain Can checked his lid.
"Good. I thought we were suddenly underwater."
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


Mia's tummy gave one tiny disappointed flop.
Then she looked down their clean sidewalk.
"Look what we BOTH did!"
"No more runaway wrappers," said Olivia.
"No more cups under the bench," said Mia.
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


Captain Can pointed to the pigeon.
"And one extremely satisfied customer."
The pigeon pooped.
"Tough crowd," he said.
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


"You're going to the Neighborhood Challenge!"
Mia cheered.
Olivia hugged her.
"I wish you were coming too."
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


"Don't worry. I will try again!"
said Mia.
She raised her grabber.
"My community needs me!"
"Mine too," said Ocean Olivia.
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


Captain Can puffed out his chest.
"Then onward, heroes! Our work is—"
A wrapper blew against his foot.
Mia picked it up.
"Already on it."
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS


One happy winner.
Two proud friends.
And one cleaner neighborhood.
Happily ever after...
until the next DING! DING!
CAPTAIN CAN
BANANAS



PICK IT UP SEATTLE

ONE PERSON. ONE PIECE. ONE BETTER CITY.

Small actions can make a big difference.

Thank you for being part of the solution!

Learn more, share your cleanups, and get involved at:

PickItUpTogether.org


DING! DING!
The Street Challenge is on!
Mia and Olivia are ready—with gloves, grabbers, and Captain Can.
But runaway wrappers, a curious pigeon, and one banana sticker make this a cleanup to remember!
Who will win?
And what will they discover along the way?
CAPTAIN CAN
One person.
One piece.
One better place.